

Section 2 set texts: Drama and poetry pre-1900	Knowledge, skills and understanding	Learners should be able to:
The set texts for examination until 2028 are: Learners study one pre-1900 drama text: • Christopher Marlowe: <i>Edward II</i> • John Webster: <i>The Duchess of Malfi</i> • Oliver Goldsmith: <i>She Stoops to Conquer</i> • Henrik Ibsen: <i>A Doll's House</i> • Oscar Wilde: <i>An Ideal Husband</i> Learners study one pre-1900 poetry text: • Geoffrey Chaucer: <i>The Merchant's Prologue and Tale</i> • John Milton: <i>Paradise Lost Books 9 & 10</i> • Samuel Taylor Coleridge: <i>Selected Poems*</i> • Alfred, Lord Tennyson: <i>Maud</i> • Christina Rossetti: <i>Selected Poems*</i> The set texts for first teaching from 2027 and examination from 2029 are: • Christopher Marlowe: <i>Doctor Faustus</i> • John Webster: <i>The Duchess of Malfi</i> • Aphra Behn: <i>The Rover</i> • Henrik Ibsen: <i>A Doll's House</i> • Oscar Wilde: <i>The Importance of Being Earnest</i> Learners study one pre-1900 poetry text: • Geoffrey Chaucer: <i>The Franklin's Prologue and Tale</i> • John Milton: <i>Paradise Lost Books 1 & 2</i> • Elizabeth Barrett Browning: <i>Selected Poems*</i> • John Clare: <i>Selected Poems*</i> • Christina Rossetti: <i>Selected Poems*</i>	Learners are required to explore contrasts, connections and comparisons between their chosen literary texts. Learners are required to explore ways in which texts relate to each other and to literary traditions, movements and genres. Learners are required to understand the significance of cultural and contextual influences on readers and writers. Learners are required to identify and consider how attitudes and values are expressed in their chosen texts.	• demonstrate understanding of the significance and influence of contexts in which the chosen texts were written and received • explore connections across the texts • articulate informed, personal and creative responses to the chosen texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression • explore the texts informed by different interpretations.

*Please see Appendix 5c for the selections of poetry by Barrett Browning, Clare, Coleridge and Rossetti.

2c. Content of Comparative and contextual study (Component 02)

There is a choice of five topics as follows:

- American Literature 1880–1940
- The Gothic
- Dystopia
- Women in Literature
- The Immigrant Experience.

For the second text, learners may choose to study the other core set text (listed in the table below) **or** they may choose another text, from the same topic area, from the list of suggested set texts. Please see Appendix 5d for the complete list of core and suggested set texts for this component. Centres should design a balanced course for learners, avoiding overlap between topics chosen for Comparative and contextual study and for the non-exam assessment component.

Learners choose **one** topic and study at least **two whole texts** in their chosen topic area, at least **one** of which must be from the core set text list.

Comparative and contextual study		
Topics: Close reading	Knowledge, skills and understanding	Learners should be able to:
Learners choose one topic: • American Literature 1880–1940 • The Gothic • Dystopia • Women in Literature • The Immigrant Experience	Learners are required to read widely and independently in their chosen topic of study. Learners are required to demonstrate close reading skills in analysing unseen prose extracts. Learners are required to identify and consider how attitudes and values are expressed in unseen extracts. Learners are required to communicate fluently, accurately and effectively their knowledge, understanding and judgement of unseen extracts.	• analyse ways in which writers shape meanings • demonstrate understanding of the significance and influence of contexts in which literary texts are written and received • articulate informed, personal and creative responses using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

Topics and set texts: Comparative essay	Knowledge, skills and understanding	Learners should be able to:
Learners study two whole texts, at least one must be from the list below: American Literature 1880–1940 - F Scott Fitzgerald: <i>The Great Gatsby</i> - John Steinbeck: <i>The Grapes of Wrath</i> The Gothic - Angela Carter: <i>The Bloody Chamber and Other Stories</i> - Bram Stoker: <i>Dracula</i> Dystopia - Margaret Atwood: <i>The Handmaid’s Tale</i> - George Orwell: <i>Nineteen Eighty-Four</i> Women in Literature - Jane Austen: <i>Sense and Sensibility</i> - Virginia Woolf: <i>Mrs Dalloway</i> The Immigrant Experience - Mohsin Hamid: <i>The Reluctant Fundamentalist</i> - Henry Roth: <i>Call It Sleep</i>	Learners are required to explore contrasts, connections and comparisons between different literary texts within the context of a specific topic area. Learners are required to explore ways in which texts relate to one another and to literary traditions, movements and genres. Learners are required to explore ways in which texts are interpreted by different readers, including over time. Learners are required to use literary critical concepts and terminology with understanding and discrimination.	- demonstrate understanding of the significance and influence of contexts in which the chosen texts were written and received - explore connections across the texts - articulate informed, personal and creative responses to the chosen texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression - explore the texts informed by different interpretations.